

CANONICAL LESSON

Fix the School Data Before Judging the School

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C41
Notebook	V7_C_N06
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Repair and qualify school data before using it to compare performance, allocate resources, escalate concerns, or judge institutions.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Unrepaired administrative data can convert reporting failures into false claims about schools, teachers, or learners.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

An EMIS review separates missing, late, duplicated, and structurally implausible records before producing school indicators.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Detect duplicate schools.
- 2.

- Version the school registry.
- 3.
- Explain why outliers are not misconduct.

Answer key

- 1.
- Compare identifiers, coordinates, names, ownership, and levels, then resolve with registry owners.
- 2.
- Preserve effective dates, mergers, splits, closures, reopenings, and identifier lineage.
- 3.
- Extreme values can reflect real crowding, inclusion, reporting scope, timing, or errors and require verification.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.